Week of 28 September 2026

Monday grant digest. Two blind search passes merged (UK/UKRI and EU/international). Overlap between passes: none. Eligibility tags assume a possible Applicant PI / project lead (PhD Dec 2022; postdoc at a UK host). GO only when the call text itself allows a postdoc Applicant PI. MAYBE only when unsure.

Highlights

Solar Radiation Management (SRM) research programme [single-source]

- **Funder:** Simons Foundation (Mathematics and Physical Sciences)
- **Deadline:** 6 October 2026, 12:00 noon ET (LOI); full proposal by invitation 17 February 2027
- **Eligibility:** NO-GO as Applicant PI. Call requires tenured/tenure-track (or equivalent) in a PhD-granting department. Named modeller on a faculty-led LOI is a different role.
- **Fit:** Direct fit for SAI/MCB/CCT lab and modelling science.
- **Why it might not fit:** Very short runway to the LOI; lab/modelling only, no in-situ release.

https://www.simonsfoundation.org/grant/solar-radiation-management/

ERC Starting Grant 2027 [single-source]

- **Funder:** European Research Council (Horizon Europe)
- **Scheme:** ERC-2027-STG
- **Deadline:** 14 October 2026
- **Eligibility:** GO. Call allows a single PI with a UK (Associated Country) host. PhD Dec 2022 is inside the 0–10 year window. A host letter is still required to submit.
- **Fit:** Bottom-up route for SAI microphysics, UKESM/UKCA/GLOMAP, atmospheric composition, or nuclear-war climate effects.
- **Why it might not fit:** High excellence bar; need host commitment in time.

https://erc.europa.eu/apply-grant/starting-grant

Exploring the frontiers of environmental research 2026 [single-source]

- **Funder:** NERC (UKRI)
- **Deadline:** 12 November 2026, 16:00 UK time
- **Eligibility:** MAYBE. All career stages encouraged. The host must confirm a postdoc can be project lead on the contract.
- **Fit:** Strong for novel SAI/SRM aerosol microphysics or Earth-system modelling within NERC remit.
- **Why it might not fit:** Small award (£100–200k); mandatory distributed peer review; not a fellowship.

https://www.ukri.org/opportunity/exploring-the-frontiers-of-environmental-research-2026/

Research Fellowships [single-source]

- **Funder:** The Leverhulme Trust
- **Deadline:** 5 November 2026, 16:00 UK time
- **Eligibility:** MAYBE. Possible if the UK post lasts beyond the fellowship. Official page not fully verified in the original digest.
- **Fit:** Protected time for SRM/SAI modelling, aerosol chemistry, Earth-system modelling, or nuclear-winter climate research.
- **Why it might not fit:** Teaching-relief emphasis may not match a modelling-heavy case.

https://www.leverhulme.ac.uk/research-fellowships

Pushing the frontiers of environmental research [single-source]

- **Funder:** NERC (UKRI)
- **Deadline:** Open. No closing date (applicant-led).
- **Eligibility:** MAYBE. Open in principle at any career stage. The host must confirm project-lead rights on a postdoc contract.
- **Fit:** Main NERC discovery-science route for UKESM/UKCA/GLOMAP-style modelling.
- **Why it might not fit:** Long assessment (about 9 months); broad NERC competition.

https://www.ukri.org/opportunity/pushing-the-frontiers-of-environmental-research/

ERC Consolidator Grant 2027 [single-source]

- **Funder:** European Research Council (Horizon Europe)
- **Scheme:** ERC-2027-COG
- **Deadline:** 12 January 2027, 17:00 CET
- **Eligibility:** NO-GO. Consolidator window for WP 2027 is PhD defence 1 Jan 2012–31 Dec 2021. Dec 2022 is too recent.
- **Fit:** Would suit later group-building on atmospheric composition / SAI / UKESM if in window.
- **Why it might not fit:** Career-stage miss.

https://ec.europa.eu/info/funding-tenders/opportunities/portal/screen/opportunities/topic-details/ERC-2027-COG

Other relevant

Advancing atmospheric and aerial autonomy [single-source]

- **Funder:** NERC (UKRI)
- **Deadline:** 21 October 2026, 16:00 UK time
- **Eligibility:** MAYBE (host project-lead check). Weak remit fit unless there is an autonomous observing angle.

https://www.ukri.org/opportunity/advancing-atmospheric-and-aerial-autonomy/

EPSRC new investigator award: applicant-led mode [single-source]

- **Funder:** EPSRC (UKRI)
- **Deadline:** Open. No closing date.
- **Eligibility:** MAYBE. Early-career first EPSRC lead; strict first-grant rules plus host confirmation.

https://www.ukri.org/opportunity/epsrc-new-investigator-award-applicant-led-mode/

Future Leaders Fellowships: round 12 (pre-announcement) [single-source]

- **Funder:** UKRI
- **Deadline:** Not yet published
- **Eligibility:** MAYBE. Call text and dates not out; institutional sift likely.

https://www.ukri.org/apply-for-funding/future-research-and-innovation-funding-opportunities/

Closing knowledge gaps on Earth system science (HORIZON-CL5-2026-08-Two-Stage-D1-06) [single-source]

- **Deadline:** Stage 2: 8 October 2026, 17:00 CEST
- **Eligibility:** NO-GO unless a Stage 1 invitation is already held.

https://ec.europa.eu/info/funding-tenders/opportunities/portal/screen/opportunities/topic-details/HORIZON-CL5-2026-08-Two-Stage-D1-06

Extreme events modelling (HORIZON-CL5-2027-01-D1-07) [single-source]

- **Deadline:** Opens 17 November 2026; closes 4 March 2027
- **Eligibility:** MAYBE. Consortium partner role, not a solo postdoc Applicant-PI route.

https://ec.europa.eu/info/funding-tenders/opportunities/portal/screen/opportunities/topic-details/HORIZON-CL5-2027-01-D1-07

Palaeoclimate / Earth system dynamics (HORIZON-CL5-2027-01-D1-08) [single-source]

- **Deadline:** Opens 17 November 2026; closes 4 March 2027
- **Eligibility:** MAYBE. Consortium partner role.

https://ec.europa.eu/info/funding-tenders/opportunities/portal/screen/opportunities/topic-details/HORIZON-CL5-2027-01-D1-08

Next generation climate scenarios (HORIZON-CL5-2027-01-D1-13) [single-source]

- **Deadline:** Opens 17 November 2026; closes 4 March 2027
- **Eligibility:** MAYBE. Consortium partner role.

https://ec.europa.eu/info/funding-tenders/opportunities/portal/screen/opportunities/topic-details/HORIZON-CL5-2027-01-D1-13

NSF Geosciences Core Research (NSF 26-516) [single-source]

- **Deadline:** Rolling
- **Eligibility:** NO-GO as a UK host lead. US organisations submit.

https://www.nsf.gov/funding/opportunities/geo-core-geosciences-core-research-atmospheric-geospace-earth-ocean/nsf26-516/solicitation

ERC Advanced Grant 2027 [single-source]

- **Deadline:** Opens 27 May 2027; closes 26 August 2027
- **Eligibility:** NO-GO for now. Established-leader scheme; unrealistic with PhD Dec 2022.

https://erc.europa.eu/apply-grant/advanced-grant

Items marked [single-source] appeared in only one of the two blind passes and were kept.

Mrs. Vanguard